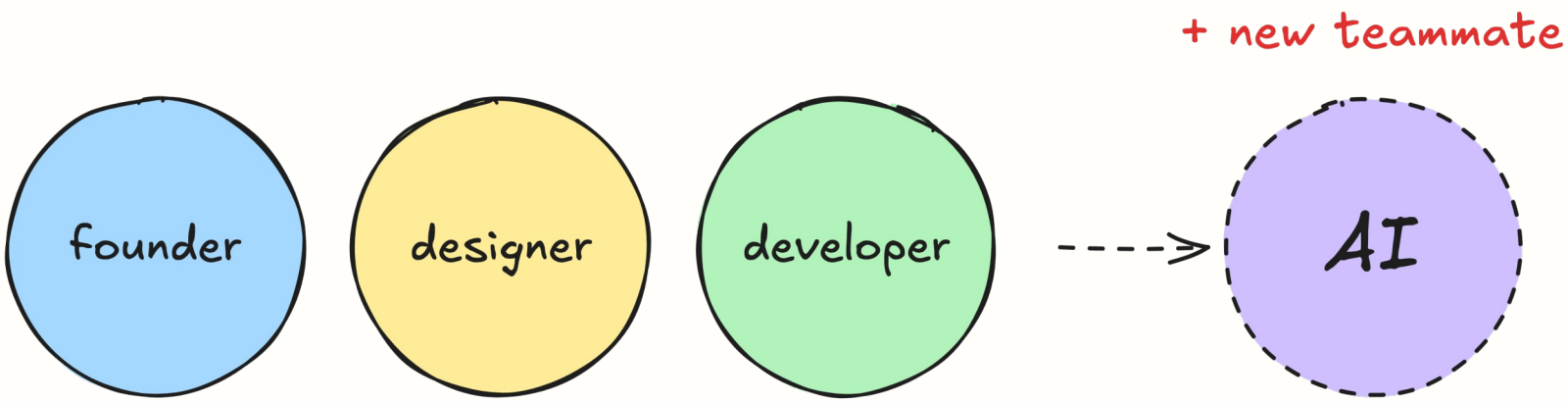
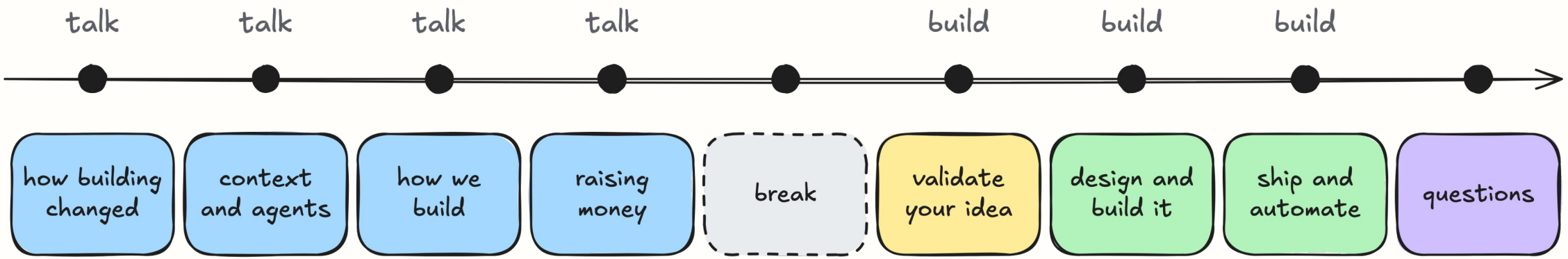
Building
in the Age of AI

A short talk, then we build your idea together.



Today

First the talk, then we build your idea together. Bring a laptop to follow along.



What are we building today?

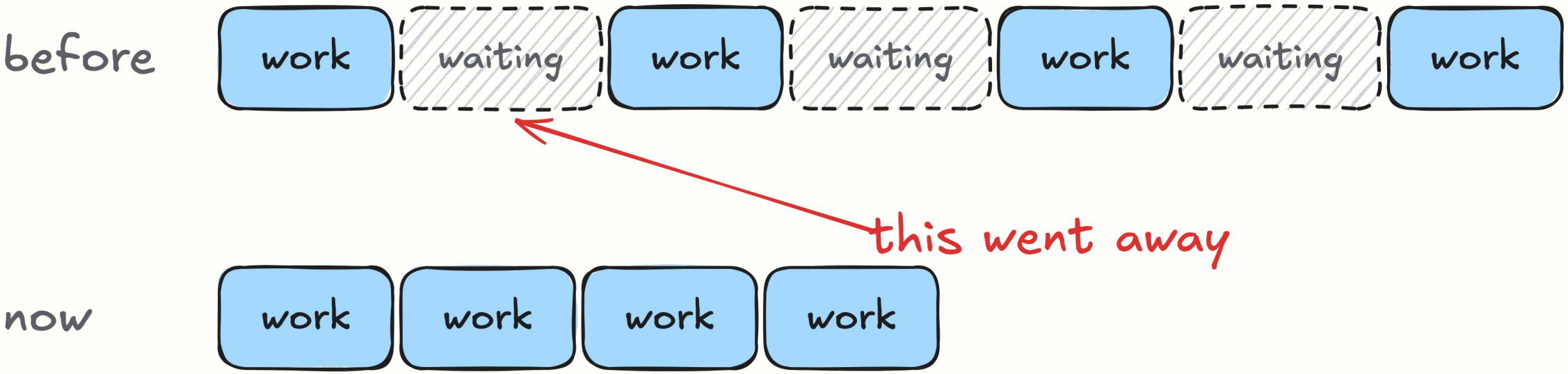
Shout out a problem you would pay to get solved. Hands up for the best one.



a good pick

- ✓ a real problem you have seen
- ✓ someone would pay to fix it
- ✓ small enough for one afternoon

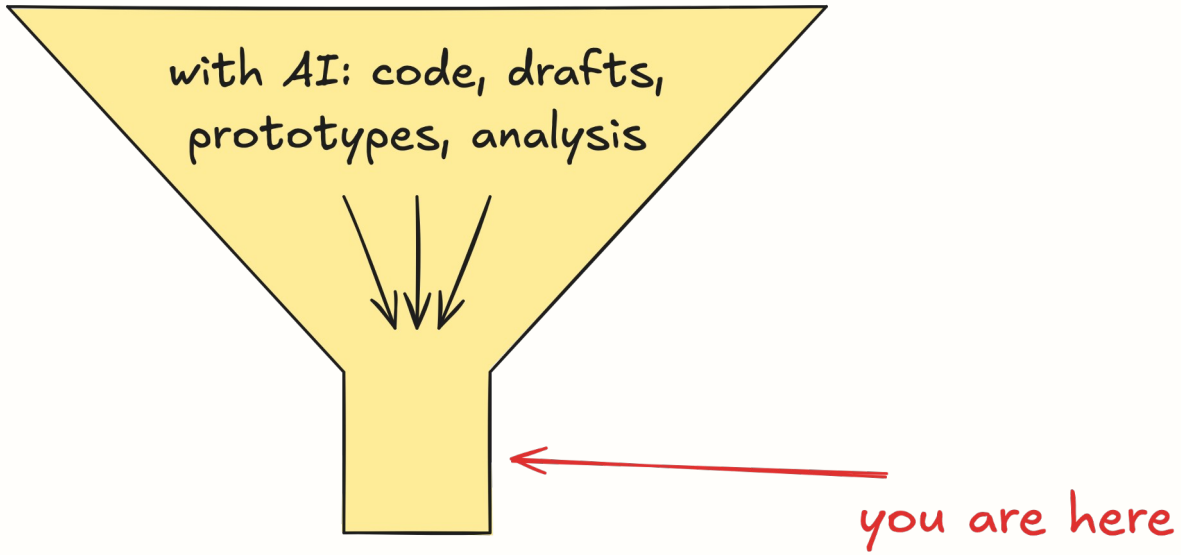
AI didn't take the work,
it took the waiting.



No more waiting for the plan, the review, the missing information or the code.

If building is no longer the slow part,
who is the bottleneck?

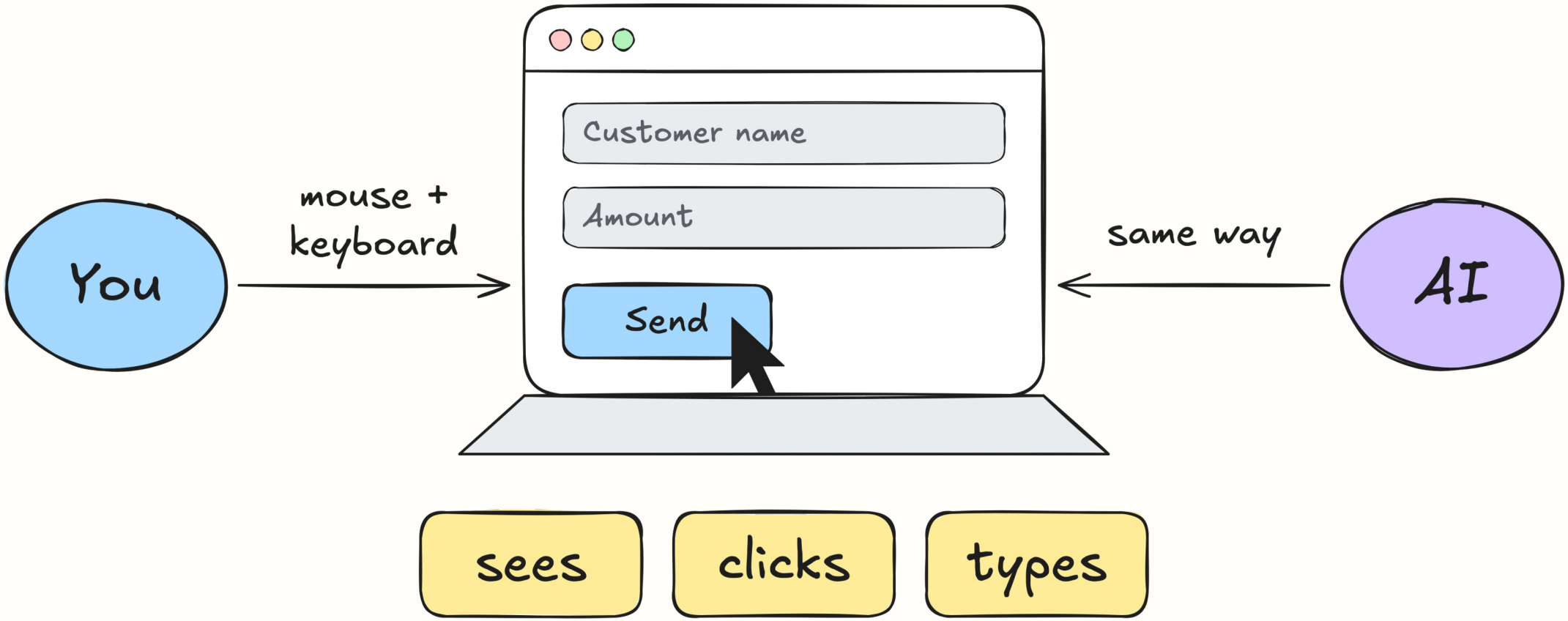
You.



Taste. Customer knowledge. Judgment.

None of these got faster.

Whatever you do on a computer,
an AI can do it now too.



What turns AI into a colleague?

Five building blocks



Brain

the model: gets what you ask and thinks it through



Hands

tools: files, email, calendar, spreadsheets



Memory

remembers you and earlier decisions



Training

your processes and rules, like a new hire's



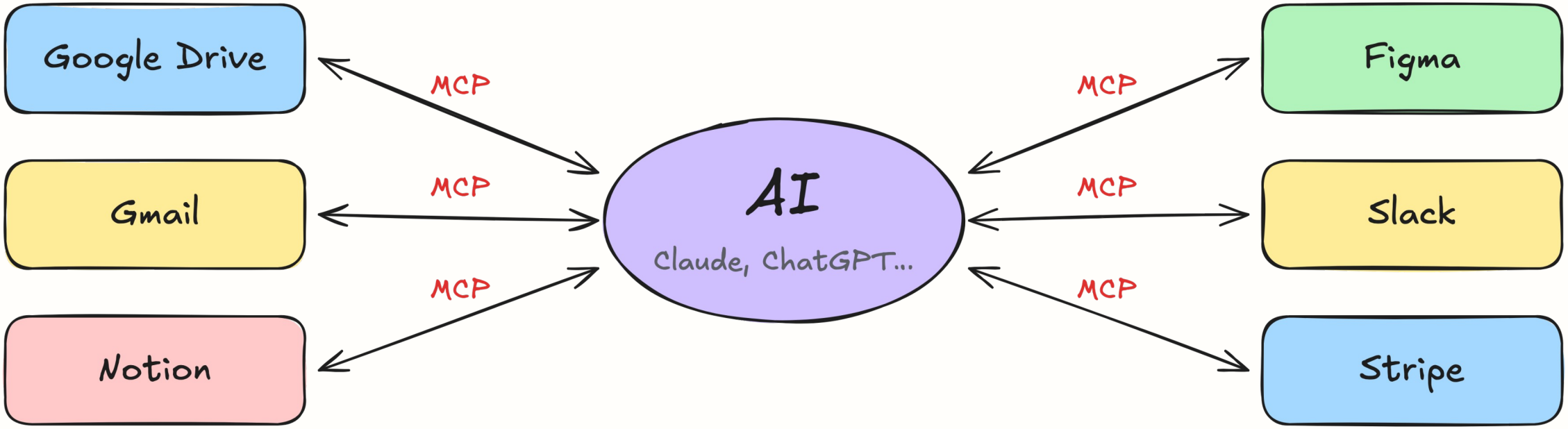
Schedule

runs by itself: every morning, overnight

Model Context Protocol

MCP: the AI's plug

Like USB-C: one standard, and the AI reaches your tools.

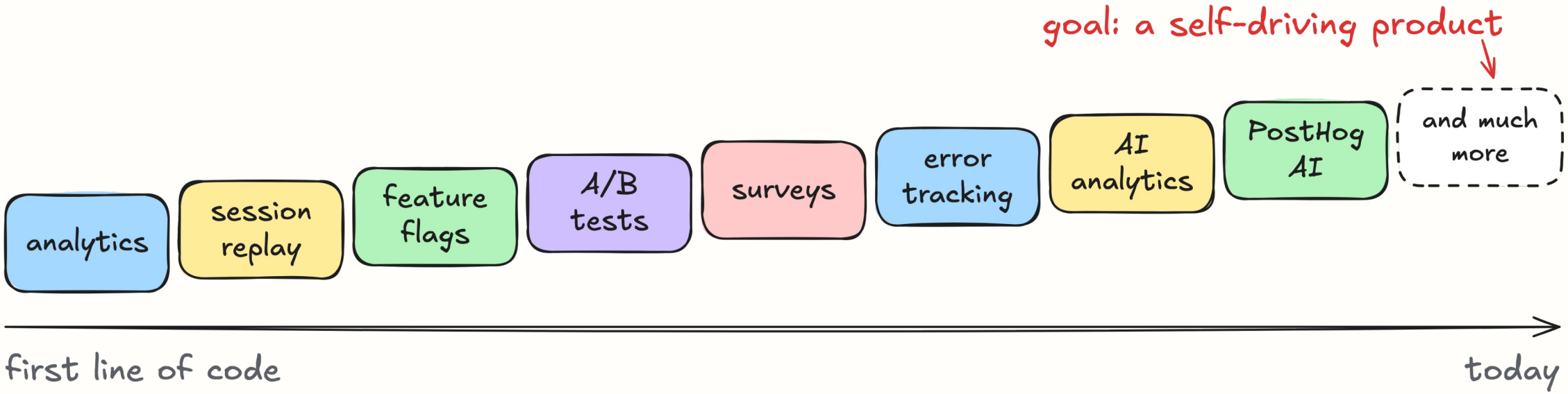


I don't sign up for a service
I can't use through MCP.

PostHog

They built the company to be fast, on purpose.

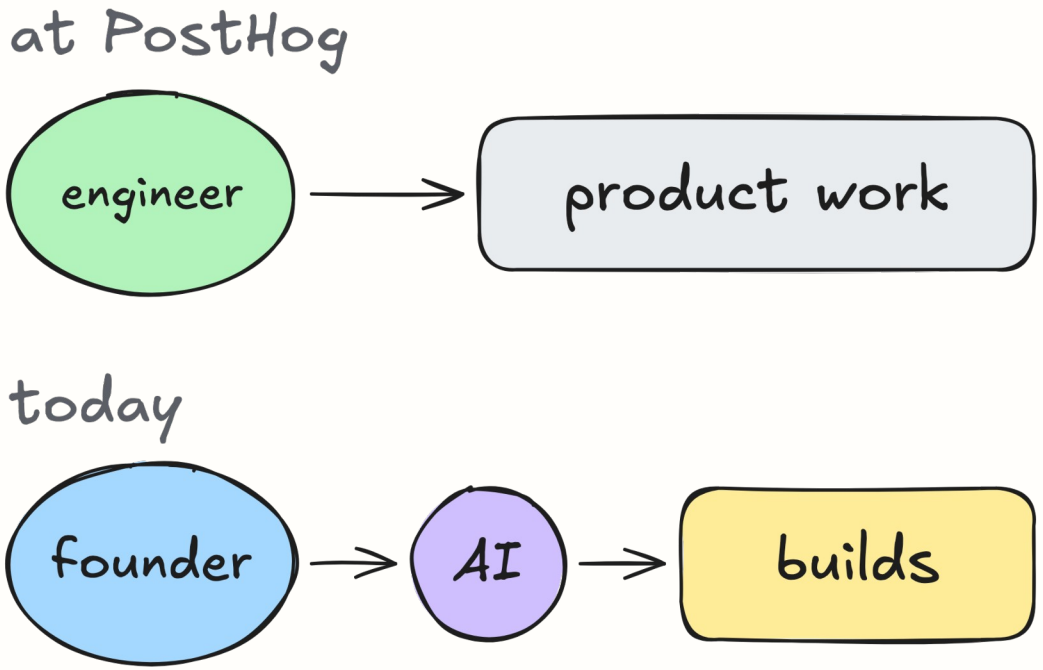
PostHog, "How come we ship so much?" by co-founder James Hawkins



PostHog

There, engineers do
the product work too.

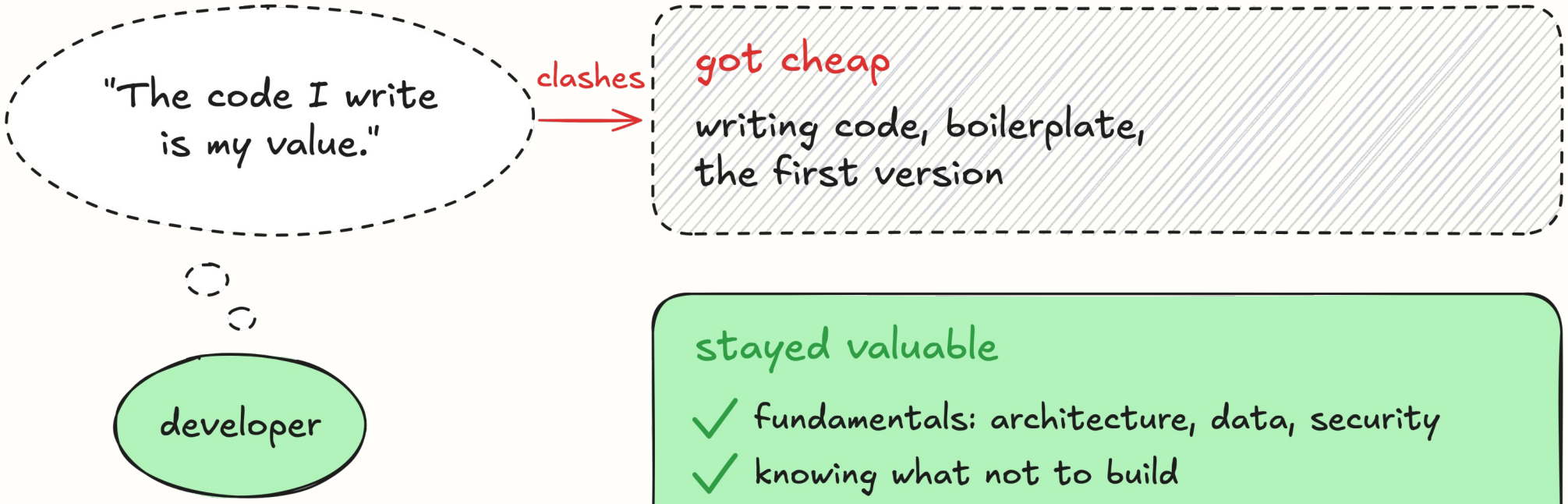
Today, founders and product people can build too.



Small teams · every number open to everyone · trust over process

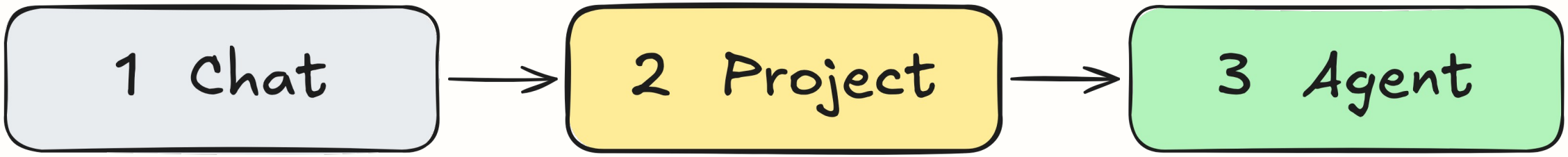
Developers and cognitive dissonance

Many developers still believe writing code is their value.



Code got cheap. The fundamentals didn't.

Where are you?



you ask,
it answers

with your own
docs and rules

gets a task
and finishes it

goal: everyone here by next week

Brief it like a smart new hire

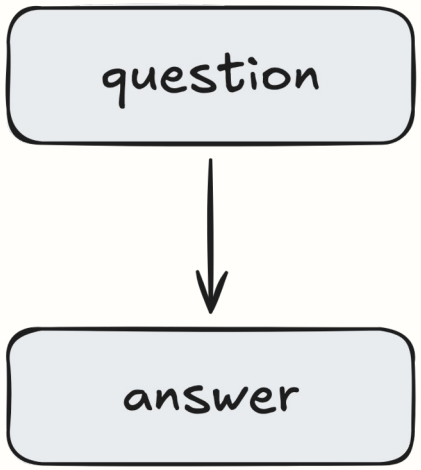
Role	Context	Task	Format	Check
who should it be?	your docs, your customers, your rules	one clear job, in steps	table, list, one page	"no data" is an allowed answer

~~"make it better"~~ → a brief you would give a smart new hire

What makes an agent an agent?

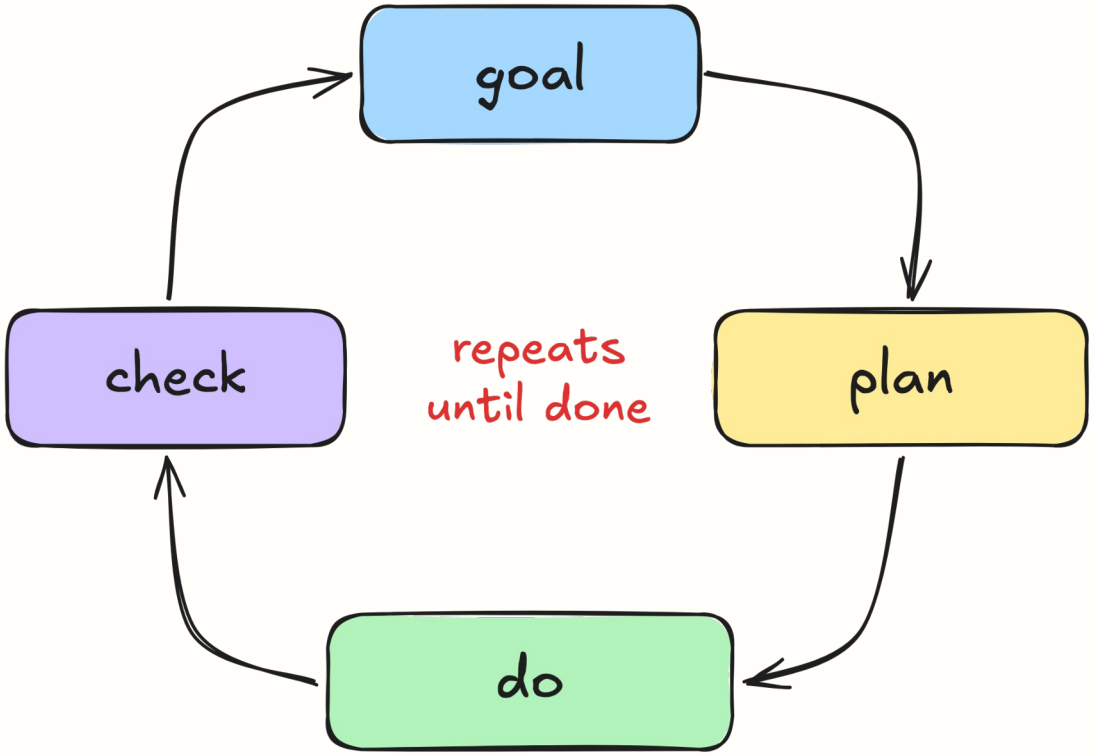
A chat answers. An agent gets a goal and sees it through.

chat



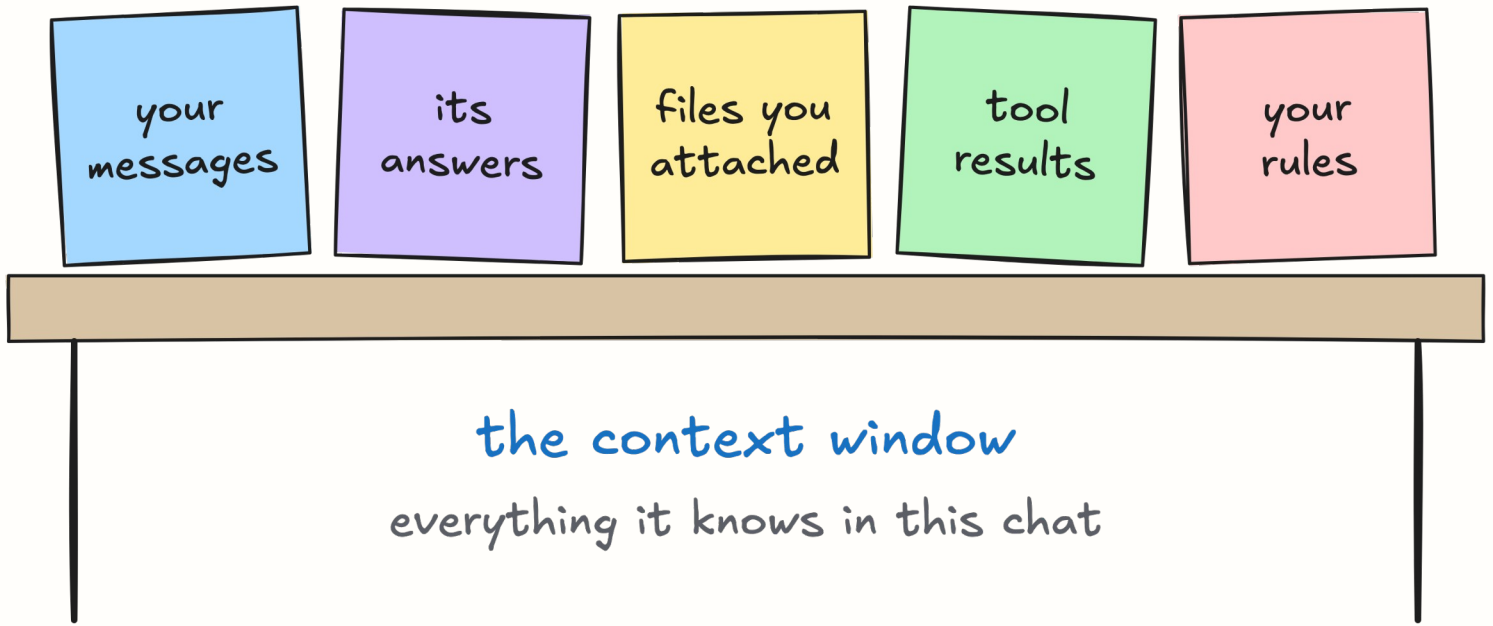
and done

agent



Context, the part nobody explains

Everything it knows sits on one desk



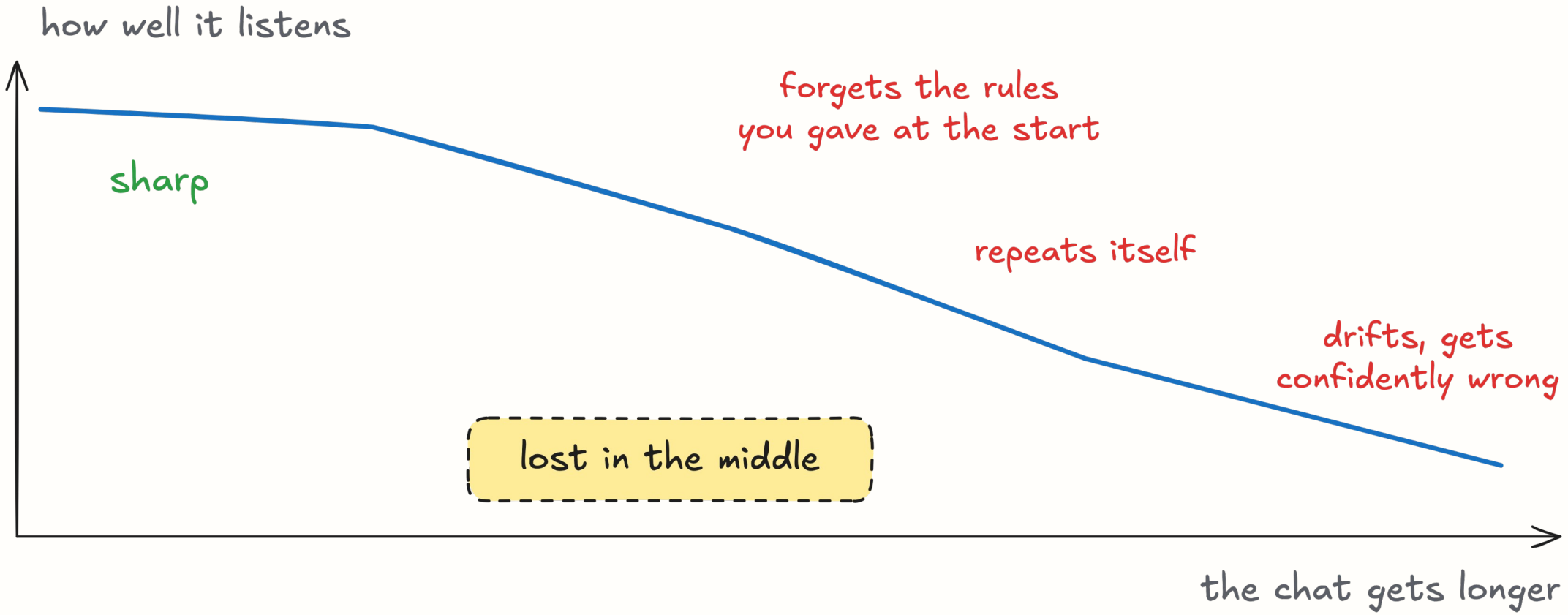
not on the desk

- last week's chat
- your other files
- what you only thought

= it doesn't know it

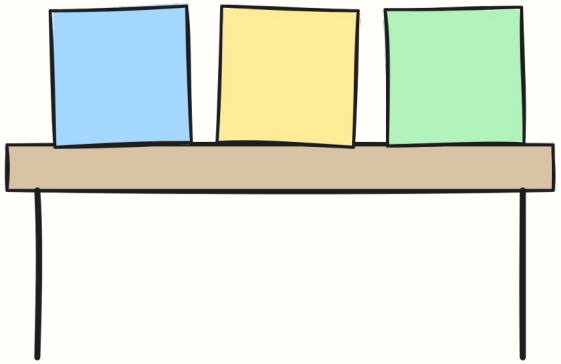
Context rot

The fuller the desk, the worse it listens.



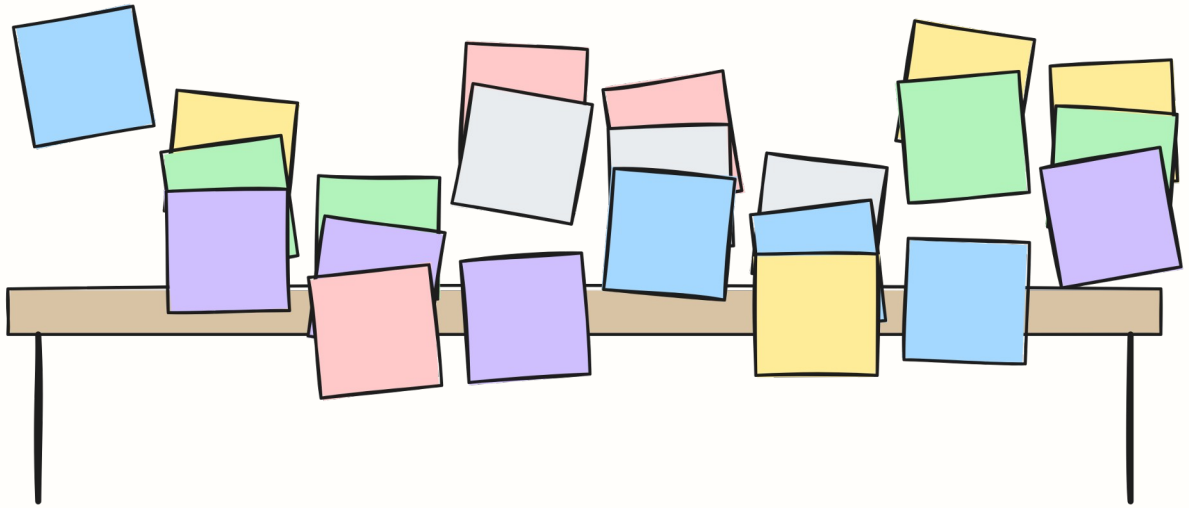
A bigger desk is not a better memory

Huge context windows are real. Huge attention isn't.



small, clean desk

one task, sharp



huge, messy desk

it can hold it all, it can't focus on it all

a big desk is for one big read (a whole contract, a codebase), not for one endless chat

Keep the desk clean

Five habits that make every tool smarter, for free.

One task, one chat

new topic?
new chat

Hand off, start fresh

ask for a short summary, paste it into a new chat

Rules in a file

not repeated in every message

Send a helper

a sub-agent reads the pile, brings back the answer

Memory you can read

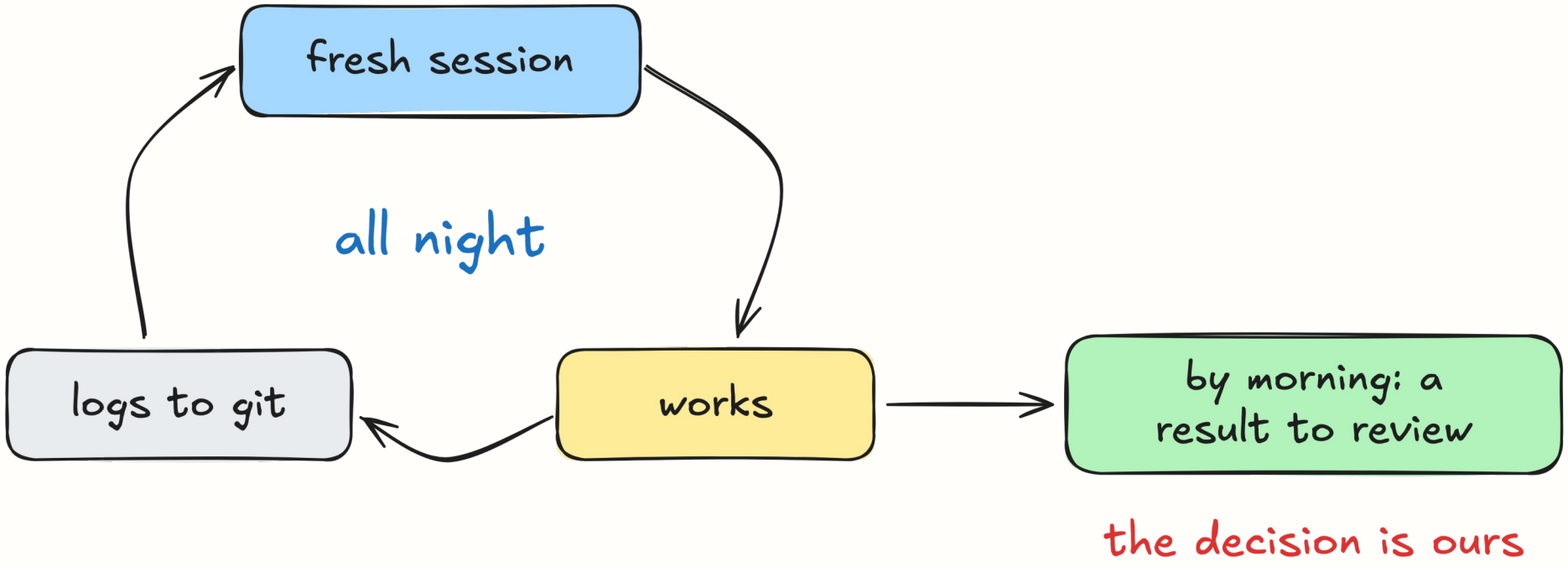
notes and files you control and can edit

How a new feature goes for us



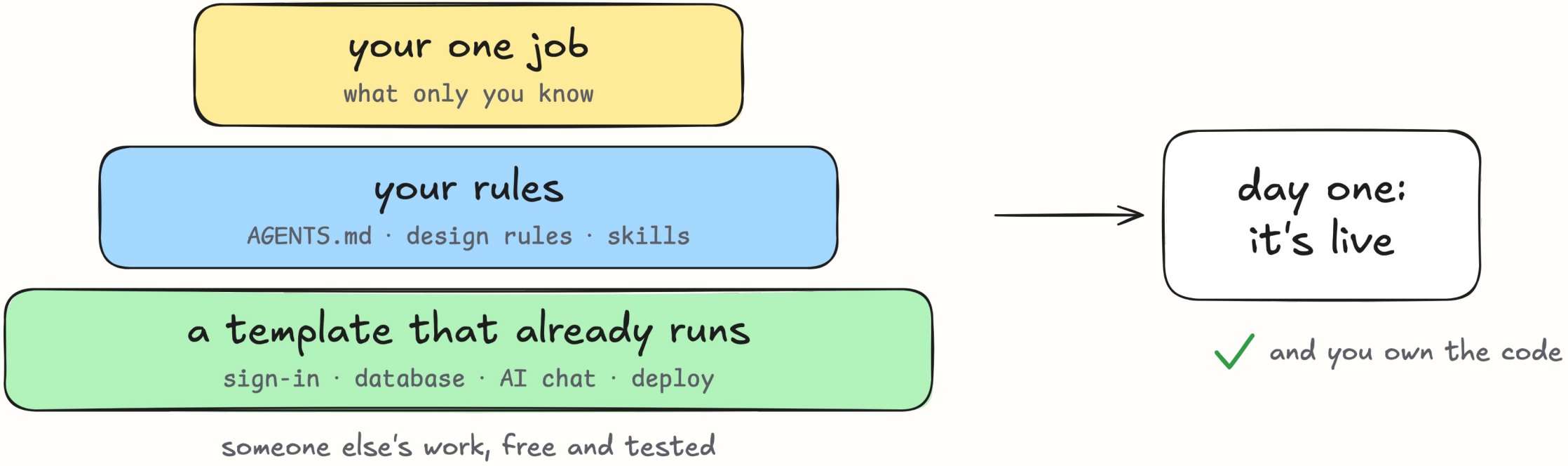
Start it in the evening, review it in the morning

```
$ claude
> /relay 12h fix every open bug
```



Not just code: tickets, research, specs.

Never start from a blank page



the agent copies what it sees: give it good code to copy

Teach it once, not every day

rules file

`AGENTS.md / CLAUDE.md`

read first, every session:
how we work, what we
never do, where things are

skills

`/verify  /grill  /relay`

a workflow I explained
twice, saved once,
called by name

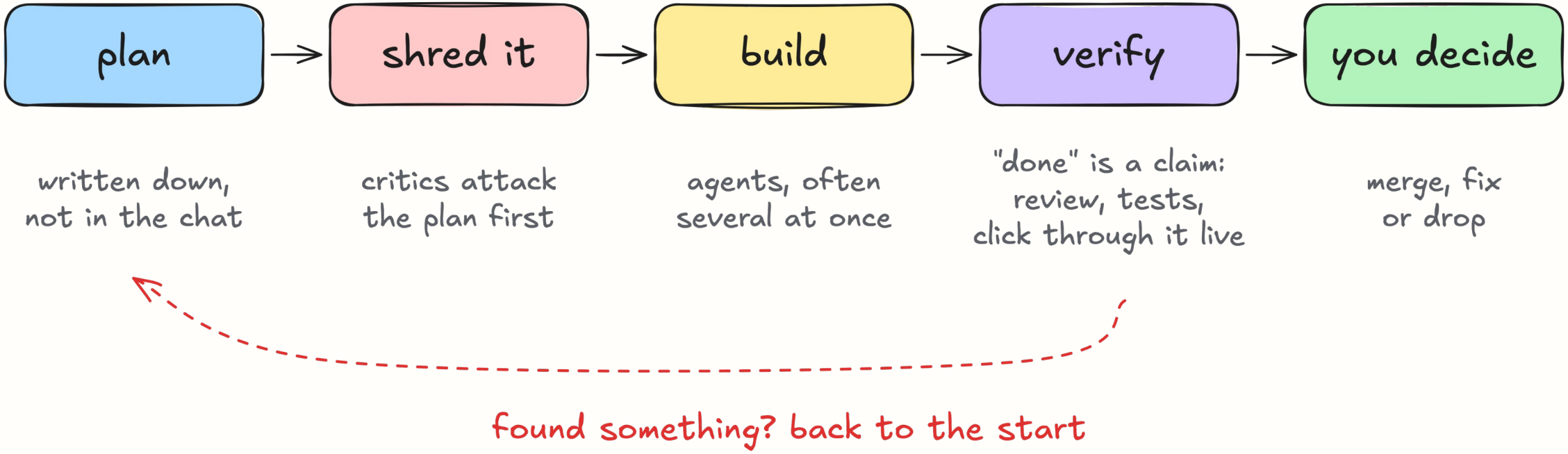
memory

`one note per fact`

decisions, lessons,
mistakes it must
not repeat

corrected the same thing twice? write it down

Never trust "done"



Small tricks that add up

several agents at once, each in its own copy of the project

it asks me with buttons to click, not paragraphs

it pings my phone when it's stuck or done

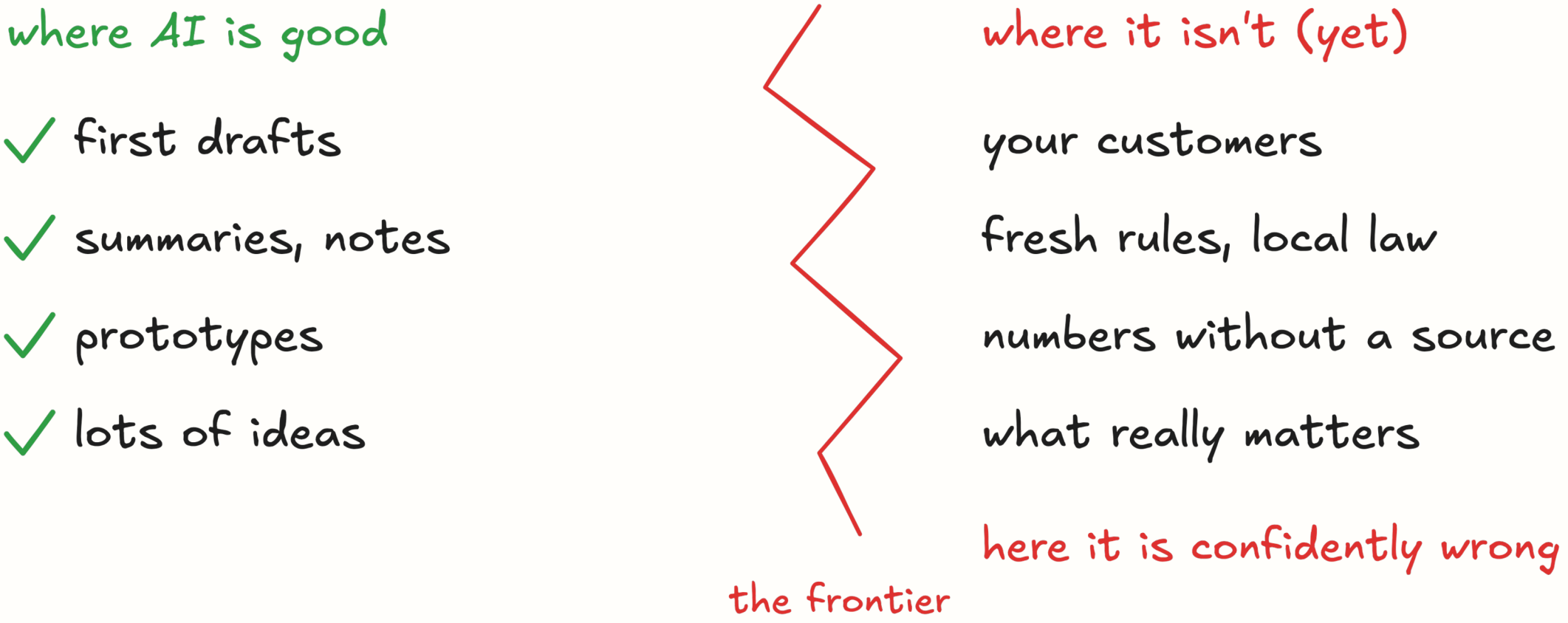
real screens I admire before any design

every change checked live, not just "tests pass"

every task leaves a written record

Know where it stops

Faster and better inside the line. Confidently wrong outside it.



What we cut, and what we never cut

we cut

~~the waiting~~

~~the perfect first draft~~

~~the 12-page spec~~

we never cut

- ✓ protecting customer data
- ✓ checking the work
- ✓ the decision: that's yours

A prototype takes an afternoon now. For everyone.

Raising money changed

Fewer, bigger bets

more money than ever, into fewer companies

Small teams go further

raise less, later, or only once

The bar moved

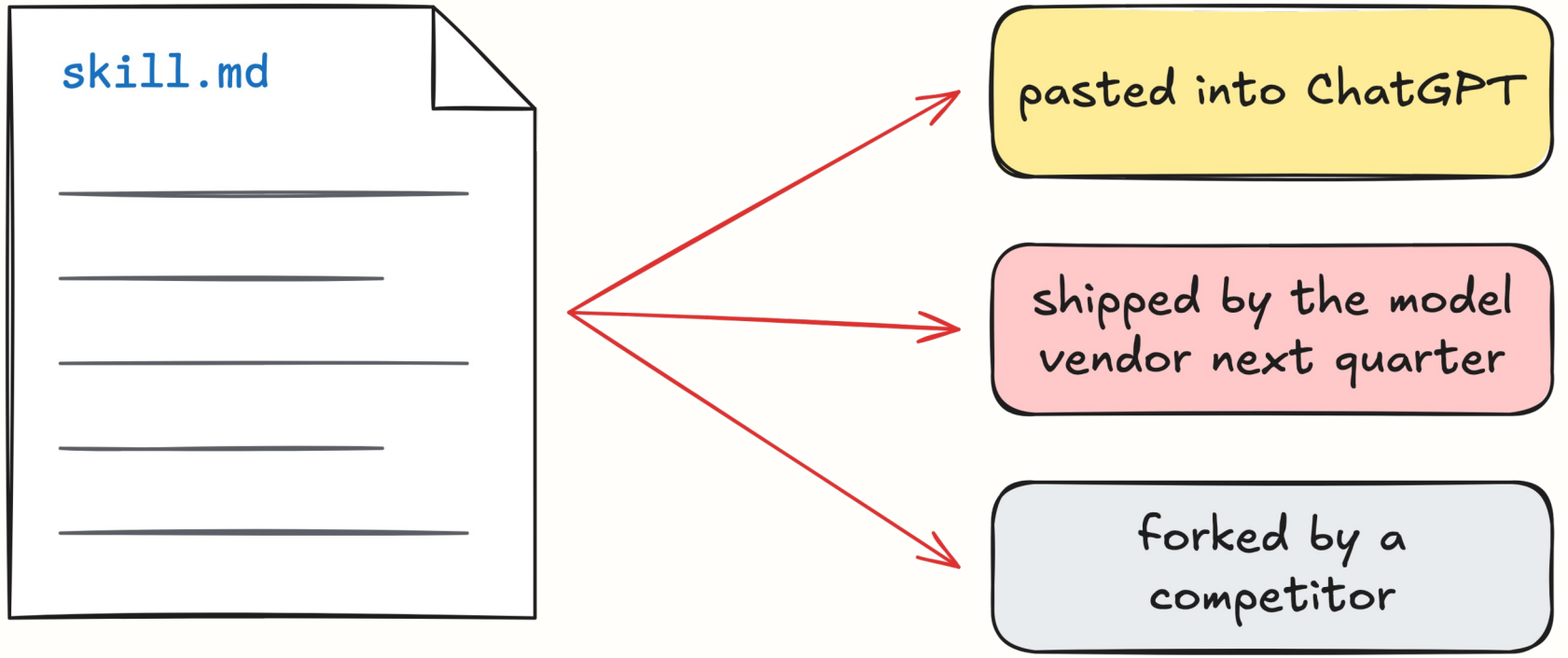
fast growth is expected; durability impresses

A machine reads you first

AI screens your deck and data room

Your product is not a markdown file

If a prompt gets most of your output, you have a demo, not a company.



your whole product?

copied in

an afternoon

The question every investor asks now

"Why can't OpenAI ship this next quarter?"

Answer with what you own that a model doesn't.

counts	doesn't count
✓ data your product creates by doing the work	~~a better prompt~~
✓ the workflow, where the truth lives	~~a nicer chat window~~
✓ customers who already trust you	~~being first~~
✓ local, regulated depth: law, tax, registries	
✓ selling the outcome, not the tool	

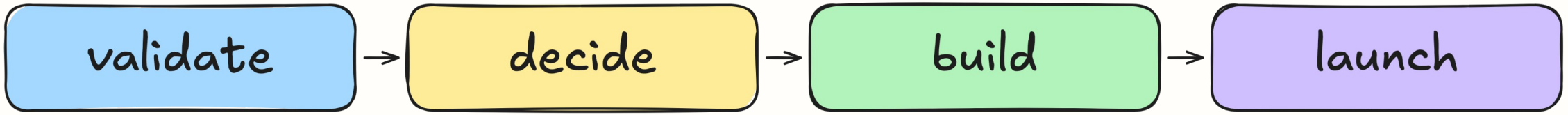
Break

When we're back: we build your idea, live.

Your research is waiting in the chat. The background build keeps running.

Let's build it together

From idea to launch, in one sitting

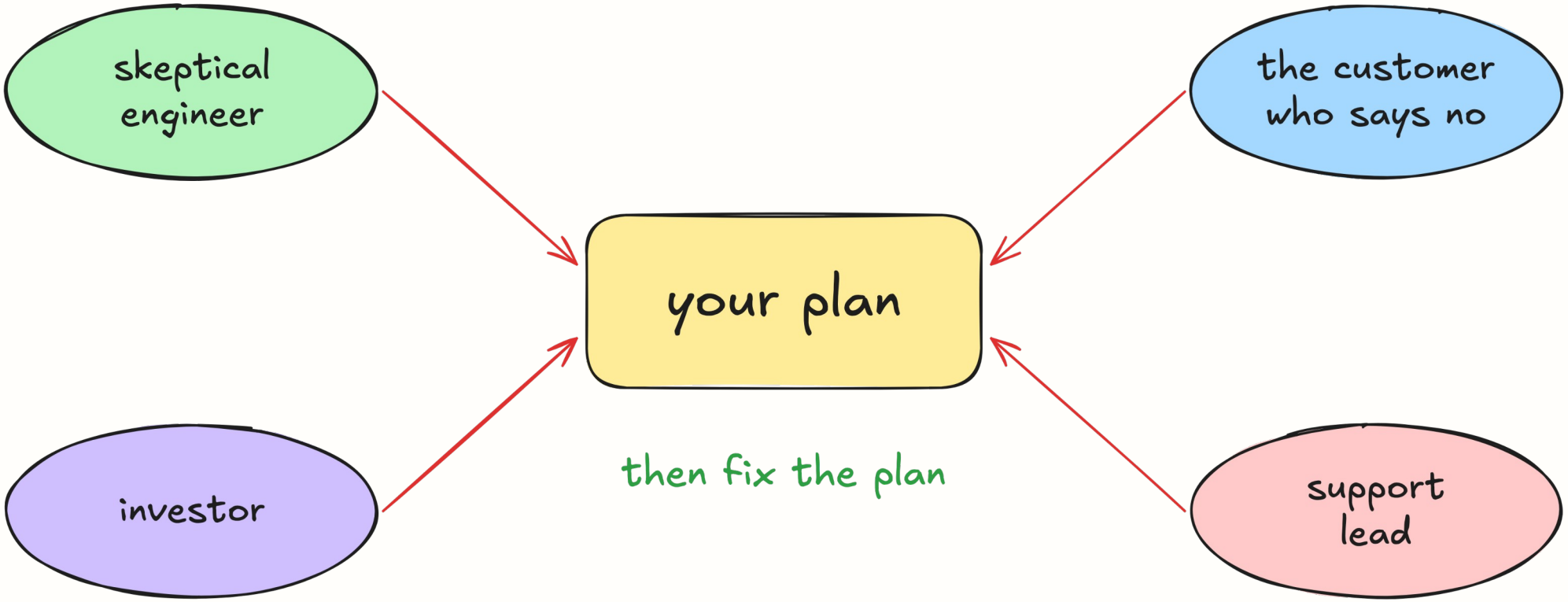


validate	decide	build	launch
real customer words	a simple business case	design from references	launch kit
verify every quote	a one-page spec	clickable prototype	what we measure
ideas with evidence	red team it	a full project in the background	automate the ops

your idea, in one afternoon

The most valuable prompt of the day

Red team your own plan



Let the people who would say no speak first, before the market does.

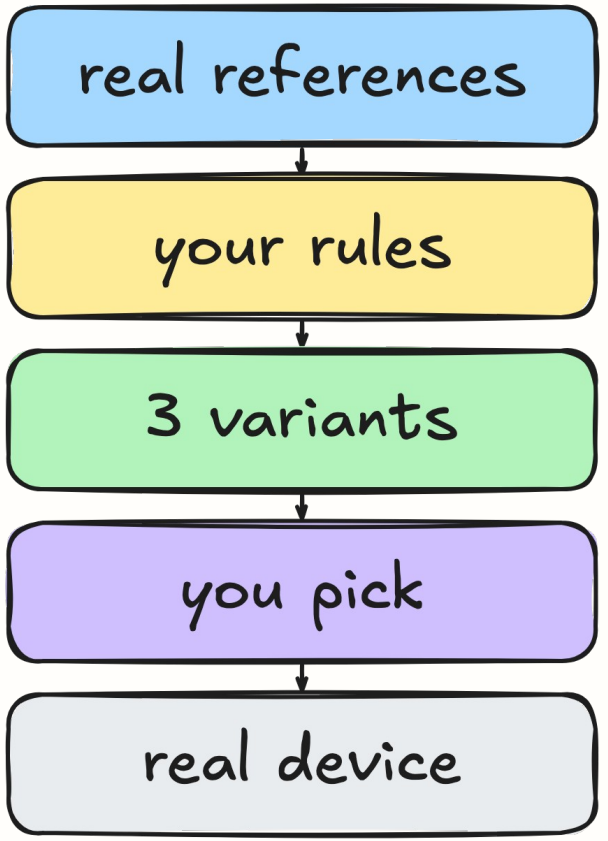
Good design with AI

AI makes average design fast. Taste makes it good.

"make it modern and clean"



the same generic AI look



screens you admire

colors, type, spacing

side by side

it refines

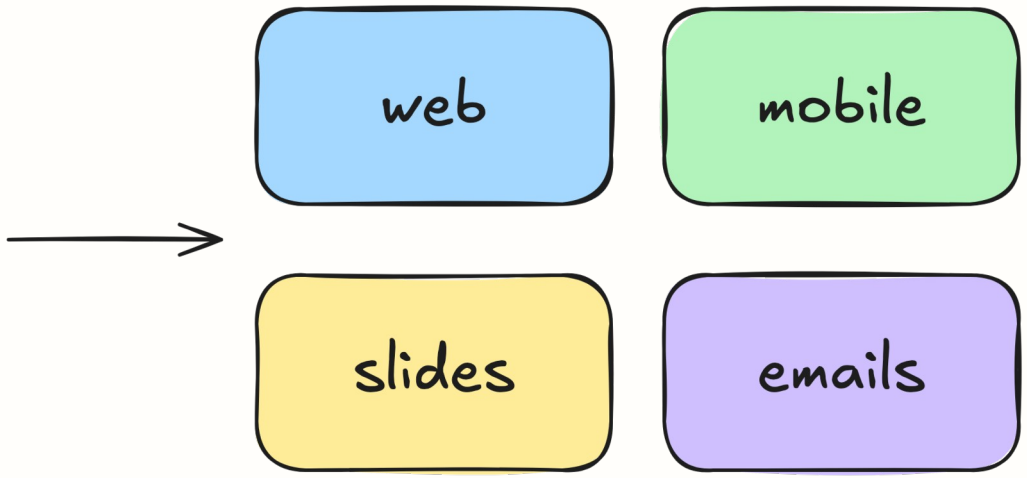
check it on a phone

Write your taste down once

A short rules file the AI reads every time, on every surface.

design-rules.md

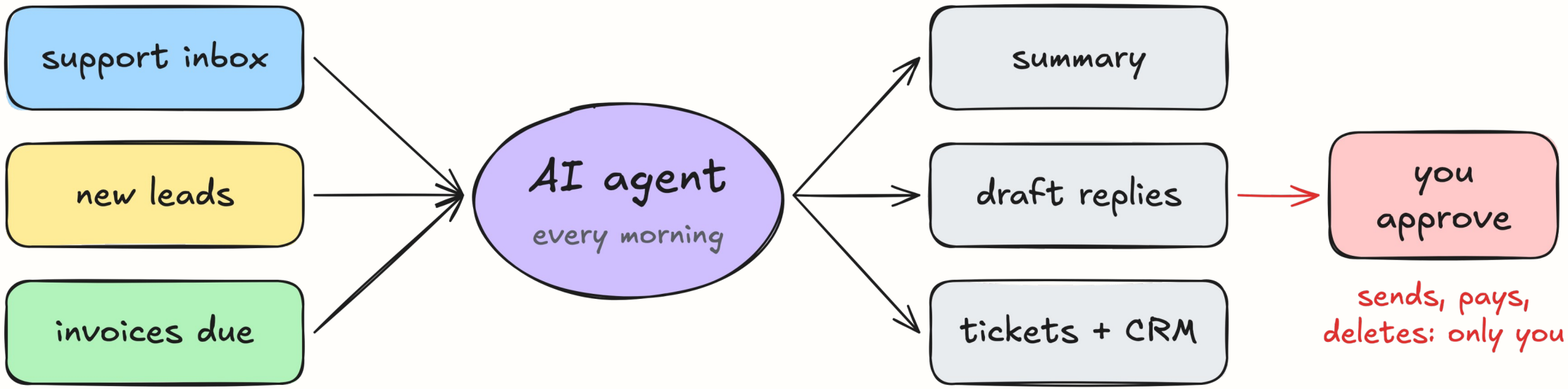
- ✓ one ink color for actions
- ✓ one font family for the app
- ✓ small radius on controls, larger on cards
- ✓ thin lines, no gradients, no heavy shadows
- ✓ every screen has an empty state



same taste, everywhere

Then let it run the boring part

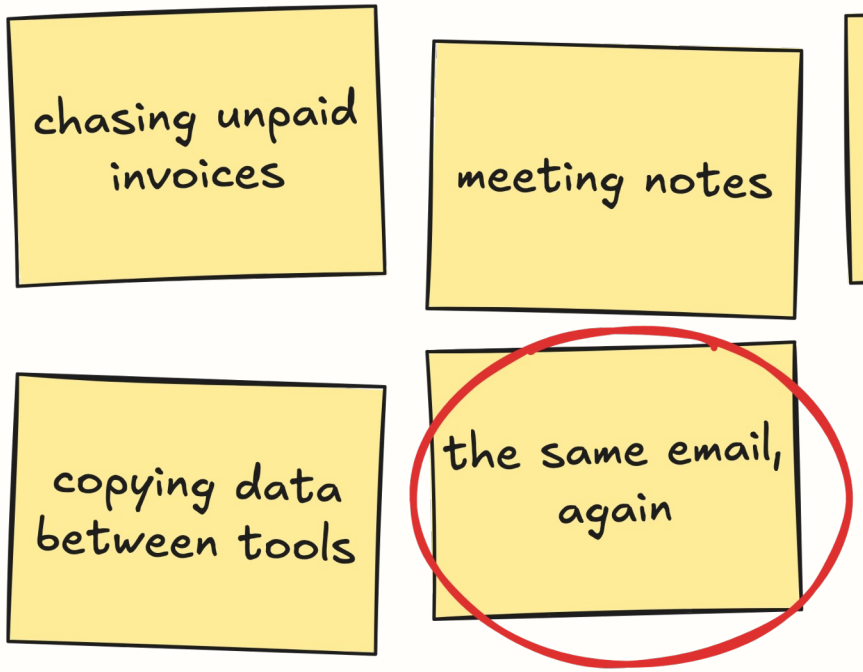
Automate the operations



It drafts, you approve. Anything that sends, pays or deletes waits for you.

Start with the task you hate most

Your AI transformation starts there, not with a strategy deck.



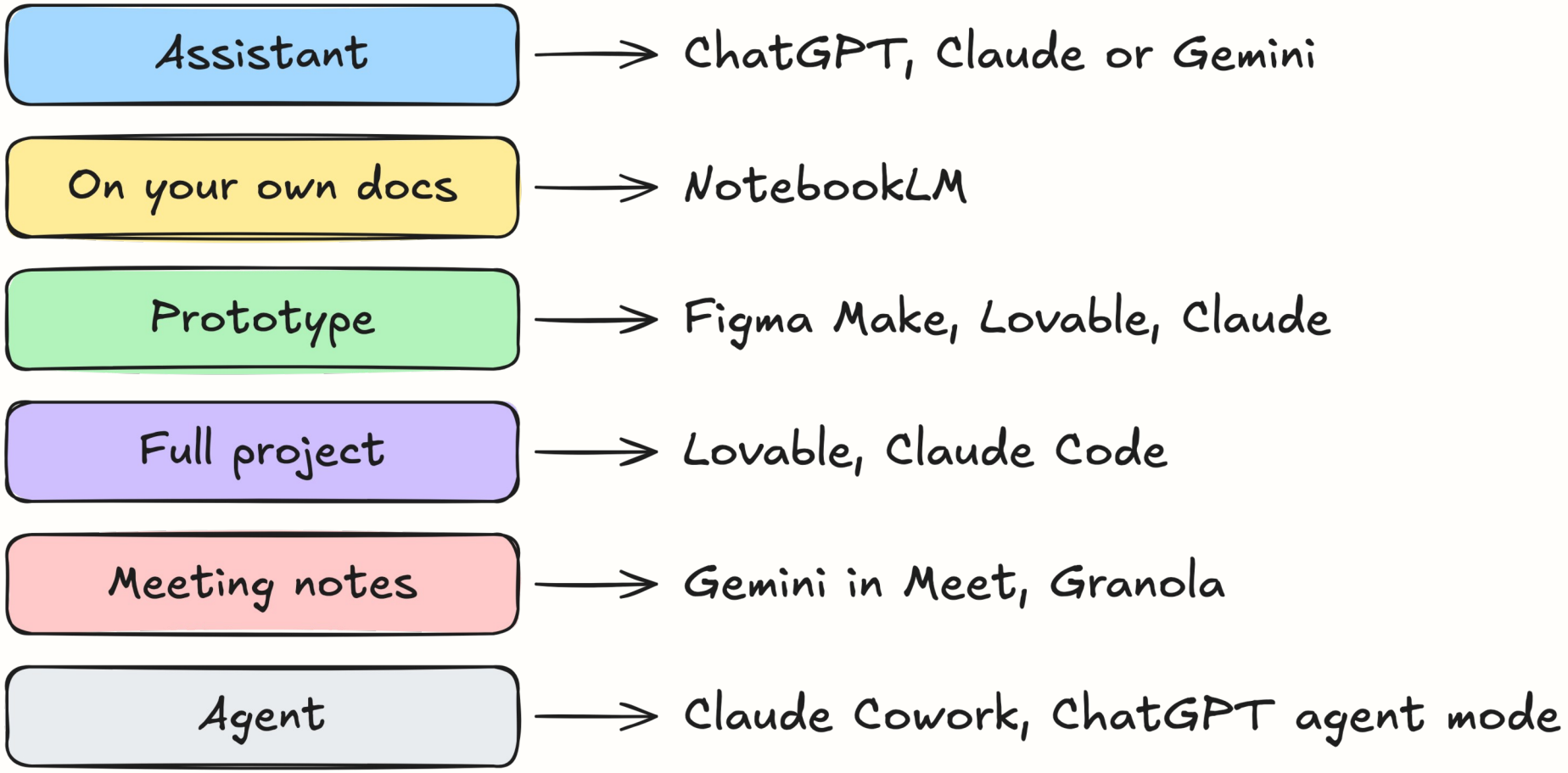
why this one

- ✓ you know it inside out
- ✓ so you can judge the output
- ✓ it comes back every week
- ✓ you feel the win on day one

Your first week with AI

- [ ] **Mon** pick the task you hate most
- [ ] **Tue** make a project with your context and rules
- [ ] **Wed** connect one tool through MCP
- [ ] **Thu** write down what you never cut
- [ ] **Fri** let it run, then keep it or drop it

Where to start



Cut the waiting.

Keep the craft.

Questions?

Zoltán Fodor · zoltanfodor.dev

Slides, prompts, skills and resources:
github.com/ritmillio/building-in-the-age-of-ai